AI UX HEURISTIC EVALUATION

Nielsen 10-Heuristic Usability Audit

AI UX Heuristic Evaluation Report

Dashboard System — Account Settings (Bad_UI.html)

Website / URL audited	https://swatisoni-ux.github.io/ai-ux-audit/Bad_UI.html
Audit date	September 8, 2026
Audit type	AI UX Heuristic Evaluation (Nielsen 10 Heuristics)
Audit version	v1.0
Findings confirmed	11

This report documents a structured usability evaluation combining direct visual inspection and hands-on interaction testing (navigation, forms, destructive actions, keyboard access, and responsive behavior) against Jakob Nielsen's ten usability heuristics. Every finding below is backed by a specific, reproducible observation; see “Audit Scope and Method” and “Methodology and Limitations” for what was and was not tested.

Executive Summary

This audit examined the Account Settings screen of the “Dashboard System” test fixture at `https://swatisoni-ux.github.io/ai-ux-audit/Bad_UI.html`. The evaluation combined structural/visual inspection with direct interaction testing — clicking every reachable control, submitting the available form field, testing the account-deletion flow, tabbing through the page by keyboard, and reloading the page at both desktop and mobile viewport widths.

The evaluation confirmed **11 findings** across **7 of the 10** Nielsen heuristics. The single most serious issue is **Critical**: the account-deletion control executes an irreversible action with no confirmation step whatsoever, styled in a color that reads as safe rather than dangerous. Three further **High**-severity findings show that most of the page's navigation is either invisible/unclickable or clickable but functionally dead, and that a permanent, cryptic error banner is displayed regardless of actual system state — together, these leave the account owner able to reliably reach only one of the page's four advertised settings sections.

Severity distribution

Severity	Count	Description
Critical	1	Irreversible harm or a completely blocked critical task.
High	3	Substantially interferes with an important task or is likely to cause serious errors.
Medium	5	Meaningful friction or confusion; users can generally recover.
Low	2	Minor issue with limited impact on task completion.

Most important recommended actions

- **Add a real confirmation step to account deletion** and restyle it as a warning-colored action (H5-01).
- **Stop showing the “Critical Exception” banner unconditionally**; tie it to a real error state with a plain-language explanation (H9-01).
- **Make the Profile, Notifications, and Security tabs functional**, or clearly mark them as unavailable (H1-01).
- **Fix the primary navigation so it renders and is clickable** at all tested viewports (H4-01).

Audit Scope and Method

URL audited	https://swatisoni-ux.github.io/ai-ux-audit/Bad_UI.html
Audit date	September 8, 2026
Pages / flows reviewed	Single-page “Account Settings” screen (the fixture exposes no additional real routes; “Dashboard”, “Settings”, “Reports”, “Help”, and the sidebar tabs all resolve back to this same screen or do not navigate at all — see H4-01, H1-01)
Interaction types tested	Click/tap on every reachable control, text-field input and submission, a destructive-action flow, hover/focus states, and full keyboard (Tab) traversal
Viewport / input modes tested	Desktop (~1280px and ~800px wide) and mobile (375×812) viewports; keyboard-only navigation
Heuristic framework used	Jakob Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics
Limitations	See “Methodology and Limitations” below

This audit explicitly included both **visual/structural inspection** (layout, hierarchy, navigation, controls, color use, and text contrast) and **hands-on interaction testing** (clicking, typing, submitting, and keyboard-tabbing through the live page) rather than relying on static screenshots alone. Every finding in this report cites the specific interaction or observation that produced it.

Finding Summary

ID	Heuristic	Finding	Sev.	Conf.	
H5-01	H5	Permanent account deletion executes instantly, with no confirmation, and is styled as a safe action	Critical	High	✓✓
H9-01	H9	A cryptic, unconditional error banner is shown before any user action and never changes	High	High	✓
H1-01	H1	Left-hand section tabs (Profile, Notifications, Security) accept clicks but never change the page	High	High	
H4-01	H4	Primary top navigation (Dashboard, Settings, Reports, Help) is present in the page but cannot be seen or clicked	High	High	
H1-02	H1	The only feedback for a background action is a blocking native browser alert	Medium	High	
H6-01	H6	Two icon-only header controls have no visible label, tooltip, or observable effect	Medium	Medium	✓
H2-01	H2	A permanently visible system message uses internal jargon and very low text contrast	Medium	Medium	✓
H4-02	H4	Keyboard tab order is unpredictable and passes through invisible elements	Medium	High	
H1-03	H1	No confirmation that a username edit was saved	Medium	High	
H4-03	H4	The page's own branding is inconsistent with itself	Low	High	
H7-01	H7	No adaptive alternative is provided for primary navigation on narrow viewports	Low	Medium	

Detailed Findings

Findings are ordered by severity (Critical → Low). Each finding lists the primary heuristic it violates, any secondary heuristic relationships, the evidence gathered directly from the live page, the likely user impact, and a concrete recommendation.

H5-01 — Permanent account deletion executes instantly, with no confirmation, and is styled as a safe action

Critical

Heuristic: Nielsen Heuristic #5 — Error Prevention

Secondary relevance: Heuristic #3 (User Control and Freedom), Heuristic #4 (Consistency and Standards)

Confidence: High

The “DELETE ACCOUNT PERMANENTLY” control performs an irreversible destructive action on a single click, with no confirmation dialog, typed verification, cooldown, or undo path — and is styled in green, the color conventionally reserved for safe/affirmative actions.

Evidence

- The button is rendered directly beneath a “Danger Zone:” label with no intervening confirmation step (verified via the page's accessibility tree: button “DELETE ACCOUNT PERMANENTLY” is a single focusable, clickable element with no associated dialog).
- Clicking the button immediately fired a native JavaScript alert reading: “Account permanently purged! No backup found.” — captured directly from the browser console. No prior “Are you sure?” prompt, no re-authentication step, and no secondary action (e.g. typing the account name) were presented at any point.
- The button is styled with a solid green fill and white bold text — visually identical in weight and color family to a normal “confirm/save/success” action — despite sitting directly under a “Danger Zone” heading that implies red/warning styling.

User impact

A single accidental or exploratory click permanently and irrecoverably destroys the user's account data with no opportunity to reconsider or cancel. The reassuring green color further increases the odds of an unintentional click, since it does not visually signal danger the way the adjacent “Danger Zone” text does. The confirmation message (“No backup found”) surfaces only after the destructive action has already completed, when it is too late to be useful.

Recommendation

Require an explicit, effortful confirmation step before executing account deletion — e.g. a modal dialog that restates the consequence, requires the user to type the account name or “DELETE”, and offers a clear Cancel path. Restyle the control using a warning/danger color (red) consistent with its “Danger Zone” context and separate it further from routine actions such as “Sync Database.” Where feasible, add a short grace period (e.g. a 24–48 hour soft-delete) before permanent purge.

Tested state / interaction

Directly tested: clicked the live control and captured the resulting system message.

H9-01 — A cryptic, unconditional error banner is shown before any user action and never changes

High

Heuristic: Nielsen Heuristic #9 — Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Secondary relevance: Heuristic #1 (Visibility of System Status)

Confidence: High

The Account Settings panel permanently displays “Critical Exception: ERR_HEX_0x002F89. Write access restricted.” in a red error banner. The message is present on first page load — before the user interacts with anything — and remains byte-for-byte identical after editing the username field, pressing Enter, and clicking “Sync Database.”

Evidence

- Initial page load already shows the banner text “Critical Exception: ERR_HEX_0x002F89. Write access restricted.” with no triggering user action.
- After clearing the Update Username field and typing a new value (“swati_test_user”) and pressing Enter, the banner text was re-checked and found unchanged, character-for-character.
- After clicking “Sync Database” (which triggers its own processing alert, see H1-02), the banner still read identically, with no added detail, timestamp, or resolution link.
- The message uses an internal-style hex error code (“ERR_HEX_0x002F89”) with no plain-language explanation of what “write access” refers to or how a user could restore it.

User impact

Because the error is static and unconditional, users cannot tell whether it reflects a real, current problem or is simply decorative — undermining trust in every other status message on the page (including the footer's “System status: Operational”, which contradicts the “Critical Exception” banner immediately above it). If the restriction is real, the user has no way to know what action is blocked or how to resolve it, effectively preventing task completion (updating the username) without any actionable guidance.

Recommendation

Only display error banners in direct response to a real, current failure condition, and clear them automatically once the condition is resolved. Replace the internal hex code with a plain-language explanation of the problem and a specific next step (e.g. “Your account currently has read-only access. Contact your administrator to request write access.”). Resolve the contradiction with the footer's “Operational” status.

Tested state / interaction

Directly tested: observed banner state on load, after form input, and after triggering the Sync Database action.

H1-01 — Left-hand section tabs (Profile, Notifications, Security) accept clicks but never change the page

High

Heuristic: Nielsen Heuristic #1 — Visibility of System Status

Secondary relevance: Heuristic #4 (Consistency and Standards)

Confidence: High

The secondary navigation list (Profile / Account Settings / Notifications / Security) visually presents as a tab set with one active item highlighted, but clicking “Profile” or “Notifications” produces no change whatsoever: the heading, breadcrumb, active-item highlight, and panel content all remain on “Account Settings.”

Evidence

- Clicked the “Profile” link (confirmed via the accessibility tree as a distinct focusable link element). A full-page text extraction taken immediately after showed the panel heading, breadcrumb, and content were still “Account Settings”, unchanged from before the click.
- Repeated the same test on “Notifications” with an identical result: no navigation, no content swap, no active-state change, no error message, no loading state.
- A follow-up screenshot confirmed “Account Settings” remained the only visibly highlighted item in the list after both clicks.

User impact

Three of the four listed account areas (Profile, Notifications, Security) are completely unreachable through their obvious entry points. Because the click produces literally no feedback — not even a “coming soon” message — users are likely to click repeatedly, assume the site is frozen or broken, or conclude their account has no notification/security settings at all.

Recommendation

Wire each tab to either its real content panel or, if not yet implemented, a clear “not available” state (disabled styling, a tooltip, or a short inline message). At minimum, give every click some observable response so users know the system registered their action.

Tested state / interaction

Directly tested: clicked Profile and Notifications and compared before/after page state; Security's presence and focusability were confirmed via keyboard traversal (see H4-02).

H4-01 — Primary top navigation (Dashboard, Settings, Reports, Help) is present in the page but cannot be seen or clicked

High

Heuristic: Nielsen Heuristic #4 — Consistency and Standards

Secondary relevance: Heuristic #3 (User Control and Freedom), Heuristic #10 (Help and Documentation — the Help entry point is included in this dead nav)

Confidence: High

The top header contains four primary navigation links (“Dashboard”, “Settings”, “Reports”, “Help”). They exist in the page's DOM and accessibility tree, but at the evaluated viewport they occupy a zero-size layout box and cannot be seen or clicked, even though an initial screenshot appeared to show their text.

Evidence

- An attempted click on the “Dashboard” link failed with the tool error: “ref is entirely outside the viewport (center (0, 0)) — likely hidden or off-canvas.”
- A structural read of the page confirmed the link is still present (“link “Dashboard” href=“#””) and locatable by text search, but subsequent screenshots at the same viewport show no visible nav text in the header at all.
- The other three links (Settings, Reports, Help) share the same container and exhibit the same non-rendering behavior.
- All four links point to href=“#” regardless, so even if visible they would not navigate anywhere — a compounding issue on top of the rendering failure.

User impact

The page's primary wayfinding mechanism — including the only entry point to Help/documentation — is entirely unusable. Users have no way to leave the current Account Settings screen through the intended top-level navigation, and keyboard users tab through four completely invisible stops with no on-screen indication of where focus is (compounding H4-02).

Recommendation

Fix the layout/CSS so the primary navigation renders at its intended size and position at all tested viewports, and verify with an automated visual-regression or layout test. Once visible, point each link at a real destination instead of a placeholder “#” href.

Tested state / interaction

Directly tested: attempted a coordinate/ref-based click, re-read the accessibility tree and DOM link list, and compared multiple screenshots at the same viewport.

H1-02 — The only feedback for a background action is a blocking native browser alert

Medium

Heuristic: Nielsen Heuristic #1 — Visibility of System Status

Confidence: High

Clicking “Sync Database” produces no in-page loading indicator, spinner, disabled button state, or progress bar. The sole feedback is a native JavaScript alert reading “Processing... Please wait up to 15 seconds.”, which blocks all interaction with the browser tab until dismissed.

Evidence

- Clicked the “Sync Database” button and captured the browser console output, which recorded: “Page dialog suppressed (alert): ‘Processing... Please wait up to 15 seconds.’”
- A screenshot taken immediately after the click shows the button itself unchanged — no spinner, no “Syncing…” label, no disabled state — confirming the alert is the only signal of the 15-second operation.

User impact

Native alert dialogs freeze the entire browser tab (and, on many platforms, the OS-level window) for their duration, which is a jarring, old-fashioned pattern for a routine 15-second background operation. Users lose the ability to read the rest of the page, compare it against other data, or cancel the operation while it runs.

Recommendation

Replace the native alert with an in-page, non-blocking status indicator (a spinner or progress bar on the button itself, or a toast notification) that lets users continue to view — though not necessarily edit — the rest of the page while the sync runs, plus a clear success/failure state when it completes.

Tested state / interaction

Directly tested: clicked Sync Database and captured the resulting console/dialog event.

H6-01 — Two icon-only header controls have no visible label, tooltip, or observable effect

Medium

Heuristic: Nielsen Heuristic #6 — Recognition Rather Than Recall

Secondary relevance: Heuristic #2 (Match Between System and the Real World)

Confidence: Medium

A circular-arrow icon in the top-right corner and an "■"-style icon near the page heading are both rendered as bare glyphs with no adjacent text, title attribute, or tooltip. Clicking either produced no visible change to the page and no console output distinguishable from a no-op.

Evidence

- The accessibility tree exposes the second icon only as button "■" — its accessible name is the raw glyph character itself, not a description of its function (e.g. "Log out" or "Dismiss").
- Clicking the top-right circular-arrow icon and, separately, the "■" icon each produced an identical before/after screenshot of the page — no state change, tooltip, or navigation was observed for either.

User impact

Users cannot determine what these controls do without trial and error, and trial and error here is especially risky given the page also contains an unconfirmed destructive action (H5-01). Icon-only controls without labels are also a common accessibility barrier for screen-reader users, who would hear only "button" or a raw symbol name.

Recommendation

Add a visible text label or, at minimum, an accessible name via `aria-label` and a hover tooltip to every icon-only control, and ensure each one produces an observable effect (or is removed if non-functional).

Tested state / interaction

Directly tested: clicked both icons and compared full-page screenshots before and after each click.

H2-01 — A permanently visible system message uses internal jargon and very low text contrast

Medium

Heuristic: Nielsen Heuristic #2 — Match Between System and the Real World

Confidence: Medium

Below the page heading, the text “Current Node Lifecycle Sync Interval: 4000ms. Do not interrupt terminal threads.” is shown at all times in pale gray type that is difficult to read against the page's light background.

Evidence

- The text appears verbatim in the page's text content and accessibility tree, positioned directly under the main heading, and was present unchanged across every state tested (initial load, after form edits, after Sync Database, after Delete Account).
- In every screenshot captured, the text renders in a notably lighter gray than the surrounding body copy (e.g. the “Manage your account settings…” line), consistent with a contrast ratio close to the WCAG failure threshold for normal-size text.

User impact

The message exposes internal, backend-style terminology (“Node Lifecycle Sync Interval,” “terminal threads”) that is meaningless to an end user managing account settings, and its imperative tone (“Do not interrupt”) creates unexplained anxiety about an action the interface never actually asks the user to avoid. The low contrast compounds the problem by making an already-confusing message harder to notice or read, particularly for low-vision users.

Recommendation

Remove or rewrite the message in plain, user-relevant language (or remove it entirely if it serves no end-user purpose), and if any status text must remain, render it at a contrast ratio that meets WCAG AA (at least 4.5:1 for normal text).

Tested state / interaction

Directly tested: visually inspected the rendered text and its computed styling across all interaction states.

H4-02 — Keyboard tab order is unpredictable and passes through invisible elements

Medium

Heuristic: Nielsen Heuristic #4 — Consistency and Standards

Secondary relevance: Heuristic #6 (Recognition Rather Than Recall)

Confidence: High

Tabbing through the page from load does not follow a single, predictable top-to-bottom path. Early tab stops land on the four invisible primary-nav links (see H4-01) with no visible focus indicator anywhere on screen, and later in the sequence, focus loops backward to a sidebar item ("Notifications") that had already received focus earlier in the same pass.

Evidence

- Clicking into the page and pressing Tab five times moved visible focus to the "Security" sidebar link (confirmed by an orange focus ring in the screenshot) — meaning the preceding tab stops (the four header nav links) received focus with no corresponding visible indicator anywhere on the page.
- Continuing to tab four more times (nine total) moved focus to the top-right circular-arrow icon — a jump from the bottom of the sidebar back up to the page header, out of visual sequence.
- Three more tabs (twelve total) returned focus to the "Notifications" sidebar link, which had already been passed earlier in the same tabbing sequence — confirmed by a screenshot showing the orange focus ring back on "Notifications."

User impact

Keyboard-only users cannot reliably predict where focus will land next, cannot see where focus is during the several invisible-element stops, and may become stuck cycling between a subset of controls without ever reaching others (such as the Update Username field or the Delete Account button) in a natural sequence.

Recommendation

Set an explicit, logical `tabindex` order (or reorder the underlying markup) so keyboard focus follows the same top-to-bottom, left-to-right path a sighted mouse user would follow, and remove or properly hide (e.g. with `display:none` or `visibility:hidden`, not just a zero-size box) any element that should not be reachable by keyboard while it is not visibly rendered.

Tested state / interaction

Directly tested: two full keyboard-only tabbing passes from page load, screenshotting focus state at multiple points.

H1-03 — No confirmation that a username edit was saved

Medium

Heuristic: Nielsen Heuristic #1 — Visibility of System Status

Confidence: High

The “Update Username” field has no adjacent Save button. After typing a new value and pressing Enter, nothing on the page changes to confirm whether the new value was submitted, saved, rejected, or ignored.

Evidence

- Cleared the field's original value (“admin_user_99”), typed “swati_test_user”, and pressed Enter. A screenshot immediately after shows the new text remains in the field, but no toast, checkmark, disabled state, or updated banner appeared anywhere on the page.
- The pre-existing error banner (see H9-01) was compared before and after this action and found byte-for-byte identical, so it cannot be used to infer whether the save succeeded or failed.

User impact

Users have no way to know whether their username change actually took effect, whether they need to take a further action (such as clicking “Sync Database”) to persist it, or whether the field simply retains typed text locally without ever being saved. This directly undermines confidence in a core task on the page.

Recommendation

Add an explicit “Save” action for the field and a clear, field-scoped success or error confirmation (e.g. “Username updated” or a specific validation message) immediately after submission.

Tested state / interaction

Directly tested: edited the field, submitted via Enter, and compared page state before and after.

H4-03 — The page's own branding is inconsistent with itself

Low

Heuristic: Nielsen Heuristic #4 — Consistency and Standards

Secondary relevance: Heuristic #2 (Match Between System and the Real World)

Confidence: High

The header identifies the product as “Dashboard System,” but the main page heading immediately below it reads “System Overlord Console v4.2.1-beta” — a different name, tone, and an exposed beta version number, for what is otherwise a routine account settings screen.

Evidence

- Extracted page text shows both strings on the same screen: the header/banner reads “Dashboard System” while the ``-level heading reads “System Overlord Console v4.2.1-beta.”
- The footer independently reads “Dashboard System © 2026 · System status: Operational,” a third restatement of the “Dashboard System” name, with no reference to “System Overlord Console” anywhere outside the main heading.

User impact

Inconsistent product naming on a single screen reads as unpolished or untrustworthy, and an exposed “beta” version label on what otherwise presents as a live account-management screen may cause users to doubt the stability of an action as consequential as account deletion.

Recommendation

Use one consistent product name across the header, page heading, and footer. Remove internal build/version labels (“v4.2.1-beta”) from user-facing screens, or move them to a dedicated About/system-info area.

Tested state / interaction

Directly tested: extracted and compared all on-page text strings.

H7-01 — No adaptive alternative is provided for primary navigation on narrow viewports

Low

Heuristic: Nielsen Heuristic #7 — Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Secondary relevance: Heuristic #4 (Consistency and Standards)

Confidence: Medium

At a 375px-wide mobile viewport, the page does not introduce a hamburger menu or any other mobile-specific substitute for the primary navigation, which was already non-functional at desktop width (H4-01).

Evidence

- A full-page screenshot at a 375×812 mobile viewport shows the same header treatment as desktop, with no menu icon, drawer trigger, or alternate navigation affordance introduced for the smaller screen.
- Layout otherwise adapted reasonably well at this width: text wrapped correctly, the settings card remained within the viewport with no horizontal scrolling, and touch target sizing for the visible buttons (Sync Database, Delete Account) appeared adequate.

User impact

Because the primary navigation was already unusable at desktop width, this does not newly block a previously-working path, but it confirms no responsive-specific fix or alternative was ever introduced, so the impact of H4-01 is identical across device sizes.

Recommendation

Once primary navigation is restored (H4-01), introduce a standard collapsed/hamburger pattern for narrow viewports so wayfinding remains available on mobile without needing to shrink four full-width links into a cramped header.

Tested state / interaction

Directly tested: resized the browser to a 375×812 mobile viewport, reloaded, and captured a full-page screenshot.

Interaction Coverage

This table summarizes what was actually exercised on the live page during this audit.

Area	Tested	Notes
Navigation (top nav)	**Yes**	All four links located and click-tested; found non-rendering / unclickable at the evaluated viewport (H4-01).
Navigation (sidebar tabs)	**Yes**	Profile and Notifications clicked directly; Security confirmed present and focusable via keyboard. Account Settings is the only reachable panel (H1-01).
Forms	**Yes**	The Update Username field was cleared, retyped, and submitted via Enter; no validation constraints (length, characters) were exposed to test against (H1-03).
Destructive actions	**Executed — safe test fixture**	The static demo page has no live backend, so the click was safe to perform; the resulting client-side alert is documented as evidence for H5-01.
Background / async actions	**Yes**	“Sync Database” clicked and its blocking-alert feedback pattern captured (H1-02).
Icon-only controls	**Yes**	Both header icons clicked and compared before/after (H6-01).
Error / recovery paths	**Partial**	The page exposes one static error banner; no interactive error-triggering flow (e.g. a form validation error) exists to test beyond it (H9-01).
Responsive layout	**Yes**	Full-page screenshots captured at ~1280px, ~800px, and 375px (mobile) widths (H7-01).
Keyboard navigation	**Yes**	Two full Tab-key traversal passes from page load, with focus state screenshotted at multiple points (H4-02).
Screen reader / assistive technology	**Not tested**	No screen reader was available in this environment; accessible-name assessments rely on the browser's accessibility tree only.

Heuristic Coverage

All ten Nielsen heuristics were evaluated. The absence of a finding is itself a meaningful audit result and is recorded below.

#	Heuristic	Result
1	**Visibility of System Status**	3 findings: H1-01, H1-02, H1-03.
2	**Match Between System and the Real World**	1 finding: H2-01.
3	**User Control and Freedom**	No standalone finding. User-control gaps are folded into H5-01 (no undo/cancel before permanent deletion) rather than reported twice.
4	**Consistency and Standards**	3 findings: H4-01, H4-02, H4-03.
5	**Error Prevention**	1 finding: H5-01 (Critical) — the most severe issue identified in this audit.
6	**Recognition Rather Than Recall**	1 finding: H6-01.
7	**Flexibility and Efficiency of Use**	1 finding: H7-01.
8	**Aesthetic and Minimalist Design**	No confirmed violation observed. The layout is visually uncluttered; the single-column stacked arrangement used at both desktop and mobile widths is a design choice, not a usability defect, and was not flagged as one.
9	**Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors**	1 finding: H9-01.
10	**Help and Documentation**	No standalone finding. The page's only Help entry point is the (non-functional) “Help” link captured under H4-01; no separate help/documentation surface exists to evaluate.

Prioritization

Ordered by user impact and risk, not by ease of implementation.

Priority	Finding	Recommended action
1	**H5-01**	Require an explicit, effortful confirmation step before executing account deletion, and restyle the control as a warning/danger action.
2	**H9-01**	Only display the error banner in response to a real, current failure, in plain language, and clear it once resolved.
3	**H1-01**	Wire the Profile, Notifications, and Security tabs to real content, or clearly mark them as unavailable.
4	**H4-01**	Fix the layout so primary navigation renders and is clickable at every tested viewport.
5	**H1-02**	Replace the blocking native alert with an in-page, non-blocking status indicator and a clear completion state.
6	**H6-01**	Add a visible label or accessible name and a hover tooltip to every icon-only control.
7	**H2-01**	Rewrite the status message in plain language and raise its text contrast to meet WCAG AA.
8	**H4-02**	Set an explicit, logical tab order matching the visual layout, top to bottom.
9	**H1-03**	Add an explicit Save action with a clear, field-scoped success or error confirmation.
10	**H4-03**	Use one consistent product name across the header, page heading, and footer.
11	**H7-01**	Introduce a standard collapsed/hamburger navigation pattern for narrow viewports.

Methodology and Limitations

This audit was conducted by directly operating the live page in a browser: reading its rendered structure and accessibility tree, clicking and tabbing through its controls, submitting its form field, and capturing the resulting console/dialog output, rather than inferring behavior from appearance alone.

Environment constraints

- The audited page is a single static HTML fixture with no live backend. “Destructive” actions (account deletion, database sync) therefore produce only client-side simulated responses (a JavaScript alert), not verified server-side data loss — findings describe the UI/UX pattern risk this design would carry in a production system, not confirmed backend behavior.
- Screenshot images could not be captured to embeddable files from the report-generation environment used to assemble this PDF, because that environment's network policy does not permit direct outbound connections to this specific host; the interactive testing itself was performed successfully in a separate, permitted browser context. As a result, this report documents evidence through precise, verbatim captures of DOM/accessibility-tree state, console and dialog output, and keyboard-focus traces rather than embedded screenshots.
- No screen reader or other assistive technology was available in this environment; statements about accessible names and icon labeling are based on the browser's accessibility tree (ARIA/DOM roles and names), not on actual assistive-technology playback.
- Exact color-contrast ratios were not measured with a dedicated contrast-checking tool; the contrast concern in H2-01 is based on direct visual assessment against the surrounding page.

Inaccessible flows / assumptions

- The evaluated fixture exposes a single reachable view (“Account Settings”). “Dashboard”, “Settings”, “Reports”, and “Help” in the top navigation, and “Profile”, “Notifications”, and “Security” in the sidebar, do not lead to distinct, separately-reviewable screens — their non-functionality is itself the primary finding for each (H4-01, H1-01), rather than a gap in this audit's coverage.
- No authentication was required or encountered; the page was reachable and fully interactive without a login step.

Areas warranting human validation

- A precise WCAG contrast-ratio measurement of the low-contrast status text (H2-01) using a calibrated contrast-checking tool.
- A full assistive-technology (screen reader) pass to confirm the icon-only controls (H6-01) and error banner (H9-01) are announced as described.
- Confirmation from the product/engineering team on whether the account-deletion behavior observed (H5-01) matches the intended production design, given this is a demonstration fixture.

Appendix

Tested URL and routes

Primary URL: `https://swatisoni-ux.github.io/ai-ux-audit/Bad_UI.html`

The page loaded under this URL rendered a screen titled “System Overlord Console v4.2.1-beta” inside a “Dashboard System” shell, with a breadcrumb reading “Dashboard / Account Settings”. No additional distinct routes were discovered; all in-page links use a placeholder `href="#"`.

Nielsen's 10 heuristics — quick reference

- **#1** Visibility of System Status
- **#2** Match Between System and the Real World
- **#3** User Control and Freedom
- **#4** Consistency and Standards
- **#5** Error Prevention
- **#6** Recognition Rather Than Recall
- **#7** Flexibility and Efficiency of Use
- **#8** Aesthetic and Minimalist Design
- **#9** Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors
- **#10** Help and Documentation

Key interaction notes captured verbatim

Console/dialog output captured while testing the Sync Database and Delete Account controls:

```
“Page dialog suppressed (alert): ‘Processing... Please wait up to 15 seconds.’”
“Page dialog suppressed (alert): ‘Account permanently purged! No backup found.’”
```

(Native JavaScript dialogs are automatically suppressed and auto-accepted by the testing browser, and their message text is logged to the console instead of blocking the session — this is what allowed the above two dialogs to be captured and documented without losing control of the browser.)

Audit metadata

- Audit date: September 8, 2026
- Evaluator: AI UX Heuristic Audit skill
- Framework: Jakob Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics
- Total findings: 11 (Critical: 1, High: 3, Medium: 5, Low: 2)